



UK to Europe Pet Travel Checklist 2026

For dogs, cats, ferrets and other pets — updated for the April 2026 rule changes

■■ **April 2026 Change:** EU pet passports no longer valid for GB residents. You need an **AHC** for every trip.

Key Facts

- EU pet passports no longer valid for GB residents (April 2026)
- AHC required every trip — £100–£300 per pet
- Only Official Veterinarians (OVs) can issue AHCs
- AHC valid for 10 days, covers one EU entry
- Microchip BEFORE rabies vaccination
- Rabies vaccine at least 21 days before travel
- Dogs: tapeworm treatment 1–5 days before returning to the UK

PHASE 1: Before You Book (8+ Weeks Before)

- Confirm destination entry rules

EU = AHC. Non-EU = varies. NI = exempt.

- Microchip ISO 11784/11785 compliant (15 digits)

Must be implanted BEFORE rabies jab.

- Rabies vaccine at least 21 days before travel

First vaccine = 4+ weeks lead time.

- Pet must be 16+ weeks for rabies vaccine

Then 21-day wait = travel at 19+ weeks minimum.

PHASE 2: Vet Appointments (4–6 Weeks Before)

- Book an Official Veterinarian (OV)

Not all vets are OVs. Cost: £100–£300. Book 2+ weeks ahead.

- Bring: pet, vaccination records, existing passport docs

Vet scans microchip, checks records, completes AHC.

- For dogs: tapeworm treatment / titre test if needed

Tapeworm 1–5 days before return. Titre test = 3–6 week result wait.

PHASE 3: Before You Travel (1–2 Weeks Before)

- Verify all documents: microchip number, vaccine dates, vet stamp

One digit off = refused at border.

- Make digital + printed copies

Keep in carry-on, not checked luggage.

- Book travel: Eurotunnel, ferry, or airline

Pet spaces fill fast in summer. Book early.

- Dogs: schedule tapeworm treatment 1–5 days before return

Recorded in AHC. Cats/ferrets don't need this.

PHASE 4: Travel Day

- Carry: original AHC + rabies certificate + microchip cert

Border officials may scan and verify microchip.

- Arrive early for document checks

Give yourself extra time at the port/airport.

PHASE 5: Returning to the UK

- AHC valid for return (up to 6 months, single entry)

Check issue date before you leave.

- Dogs: tapeworm treatment done 1–5 days before

Must be recorded in the AHC by a vet.

- Next trip = new AHC

Every trip needs a fresh certificate.

■ Per Trip Cost: £150–£400 per pet

AHC: £100–300 | Rabies booster: £60–100 | Worming (dogs): £30–60 • Two pets = double.

Official Resources & Disclaimer

GOV.UK: gov.uk/take-pet-abroad • RCVS Vet Finder: findavet.rcvs.org.uk

This checklist provides general guidance only. Always verify current requirements with an Official Veterinarian and check GOV.UK before travel.